

## What is Google Cast?

Simply put, Google Cast is a proprietary protocol developed by Google that allows you to mirror, stream, or "cast" media or apps from your phone wirelessly to your TV or Monitor. It works through an implementation of Wi-Fi Direct to transfer the video output or sound from your phone directly to the receiver. If this is the first time you're hearing about Google Cast, you might know it better by its retail name of 'Chromecast Built In'. Google Cast was first released on July 24th, 2013, alongside the first Chromecast player.



# Google Cast

The Google Cast Logo

Now, where have we heard all this before? Sounds suspiciously like AirPlay doesn't it? Well, Google Cast was Google's answer to AirPlay. While the two may look very similar on the outside, they are vastly different in how they work on the inside, a rift further widened by the two completely different platforms. While AirPlay is exclusive to the Apple ecosystem, Google Cast can work with a wide range of devices. The supported operating systems list includes Android 4.1+, iOS 7.0+, Microsoft Windows 7+, macOS 10.7+, and Chrome OS... which is pretty much every major operating system out there. Except Linux weirdly enough – sorry developers; you'll have to dual-boot Windows for this! Chromecast is also built into a wide range of products, from the Nexus player to soundbars, smart TV's etc.

## What can you do with Chromecast Built in?

You essentially have two methods of casting something. One is straight forward screen mirroring. Whatever appears on your phone screen gets mirrored on the other bigger screen. The second method is using an app that has the casting functionality built in. Using a supported app, like YouTube for example, you can queue up videos to play on the big screen while you continued using your phone for something else. This feature right here is what propelled Google Cast to the top, beating out older Wireless Streaming standards like Miracast out of the way.